

EFW ALUMNI COMMUNITY

Edit YAML Content and Create a Pull Request on GitHub

Step-by-step guide for non-developer administrators

Goal Edit one or more YAML files on the dev-info branch, then send all changes to the dev branch in one Pull Request.

Repository

<https://github.com/alumni-efw/alumni-efw.github.io>

Item	Example
Branch for editing	dev-info
Pull Request destination	dev
Files to edit	YAML files under the _data folder
Final merge	Completed by the developer after review

Most important rule It is OK to have one commit for each file. Finish all file edits first, then create only one Pull Request.

Version 1.0 | July 2026

Quick Overview

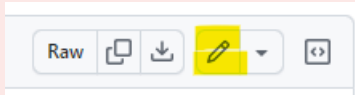
1. Sign in to GitHub.
2. Open the EFW website repository.
3. Change the branch to dev-info.
4. Open and edit a YAML file under `_data`.
5. Commit the file directly to dev-info.
6. Repeat the edit and commit steps for any other files.
7. After all edits are finished, create one Pull Request.
8. Confirm base: dev and compare: dev-info.
9. Send the Pull Request to the developer for review.

Example If you edit `talk-time.yml`, `job-training.yml`, and `about-us.yml`, you may have three commits. You still create only one Pull Request.

Before You Start

- A GitHub account
- Write access to the `alumni-efw/alumni-efw.github.io` repository
- The exact text, date, time, or link that you need to change
- A copy of the old content, if possible

No edit access? If you do not see the pencil-shaped Edit button, send your GitHub username to the repository administrator and ask for access.



1. Sign In to GitHub

1. Open <https://github.com> in your web browser.
2. Select Sign in in the top-right corner.
3. Enter your Username or email address and Password.
4. Select Sign in.
5. If GitHub asks for two-factor authentication, enter the code from your authentication app, text message, or security key.

Security Do not share your password or two-factor authentication code. On a shared computer, sign out when your work is finished.

2. Open the EFW Repository

The easiest method is to open this address:

github.com/alumni-efw/alumni-efw.github.io

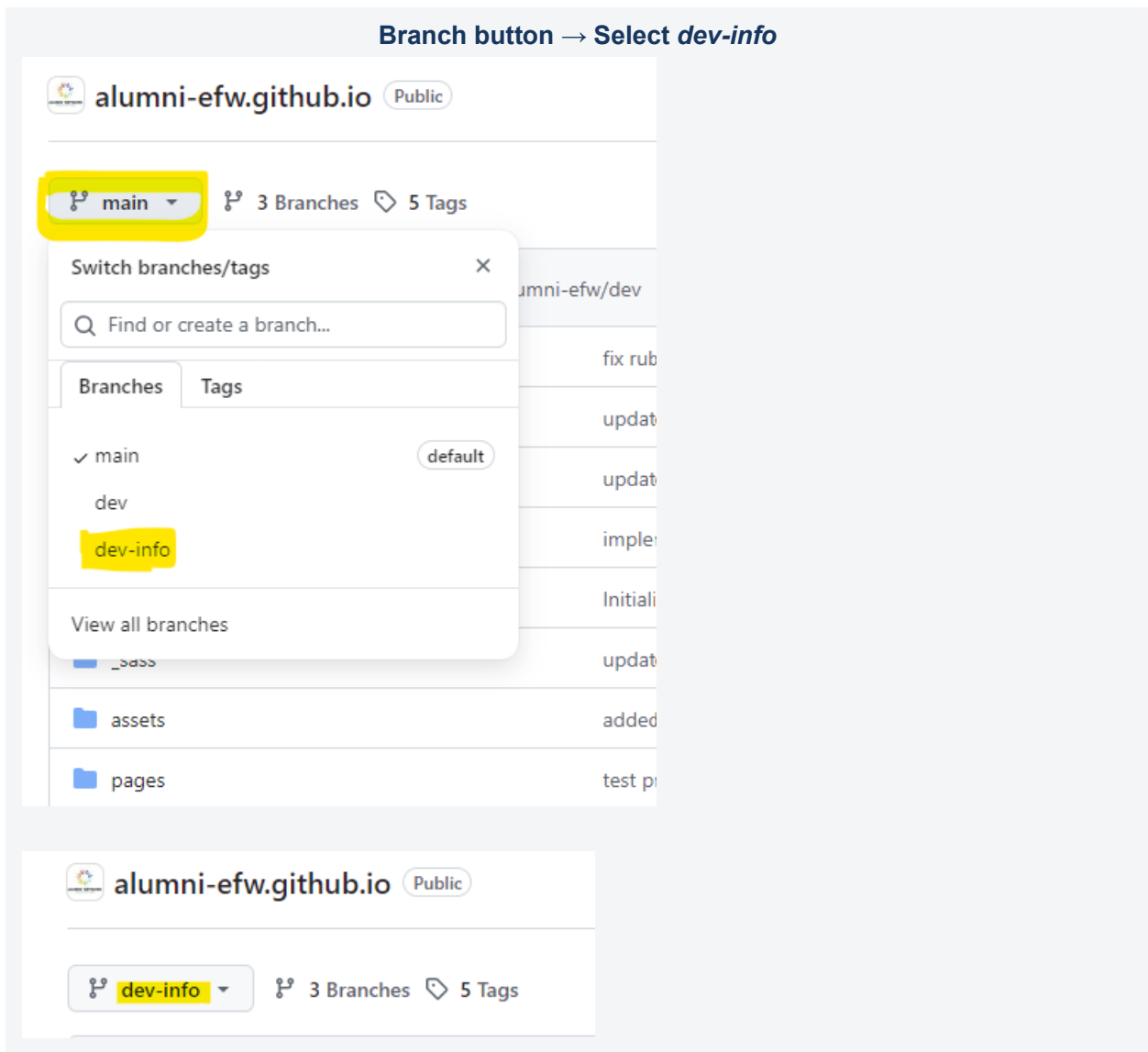
You can also use the GitHub menus:

1. Select your profile picture in the top-right corner.
2. Select Your organizations.
3. Select the *alumni-efw* organization.
4. Open the Repositories tab and select *alumni-efw.github.io*.

3. Select the dev-info Branch

The current default branch name appears above the file list. It may show *main* branch.

1. Select the branch button above the file list.
2. Find *dev-info* under the *Branches* tab select *dev-info*.
3. Confirm that the branch button now shows *dev-info*.



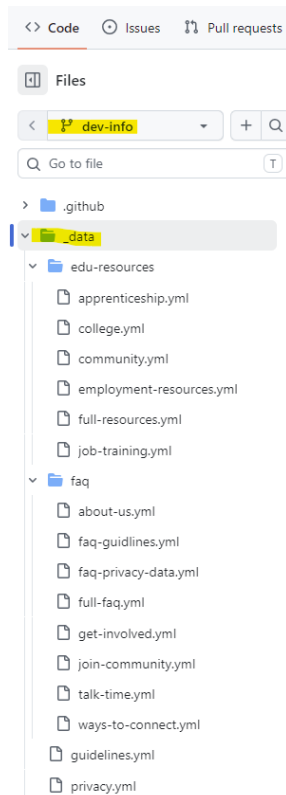
Important Always confirm that you are on dev-info before opening a file. Do not edit content directly on main or dev.

4. Find the YAML(.yml) File to update content

Information content files are mainly stored under the **_data** folder.

Page	Folder structure
Adult Education and employment resources https://alumni-efw.github.io/adult-education-resources/	_data/edu-resources/
Frequently asked questions https://alumni-efw.github.io/faq/	_data/faq/
Community guidelines https://alumni-efw.github.io/guidelines/	_data/guidelines.yml
Privacy information https://alumni-efw.github.io/privacy/	_data/privacy.yml

1. Select **_data** in the file list.
2. If needed, select the *edu-resources* or *faq* folder.
3. Select the **.yml** file that you need to edit.



- **edu-resources:** information for adult education and employment page
 - full-resources.yml: meta data file for define section order, anchor information, and pdf location
- **faq:** FAQ data for both a full FAQ page and FAQ block. If you set *highlighted: true*, the FAQ item will also appear on FAQ section in the individual pages.
 - full-faq.yml: meta data file for define section order in a full FAQ page.
- **guidelines.yml:** Community Guidelines contents
- **privacy.yml:** Privacy & Data Notice contents

5. Edit a YAML File in the GitHub Website

1. Select the pencil-shaped icon (*Edit this file*) near the top-right of the file.
2. Find the text that you need to change. You can use Ctrl+F in your browser.
3. Change only the required value. Keep the comment, formatting, and spacing the same.
4. Please read the comments carefully and follow the instruction.
5. Select *Preview* changes to review your work.

In *Preview* changes, removed content is red and new content is green.

The screenshot displays the GitHub web interface for editing a file. The file path is `alumni-efw.github.io / _data / edu-resources / college.yml`. The commit history shows a recent update by `jenny-jhkim` titled "updated South Seattle College info and Hopelink link". The file content is a YAML file with the following structure:

```

1  # How to add or edit resources
2  # IMPORTANT:
3  # - Put ONE space after each colon [:]
4  # - Keep the same indentation (spaces)
5  # - Do not remove the dash [-]
6  # The dash means "start of a new item"
7
8  title: College Classes & Programs

```

Below the code editor, the 'Preview' tab is active, showing a diff view. The changes are as follows:

Line	Original Content	Edited Content
38	email: eslbats@bellevuecollege.edu	email: eslbats@bellevuecollege.edu
39	website: https://www.bellevuecollege.edu/bats/esl/	website: https://www.bellevuecollege.edu/bats/esl/
40		
41	- program: ABE	- program: ABE (Test)
42	email: abe@bellevuecollege.edu	email: abe@bellevuecollege.edu
43	website: https://www.bellevuecollege.edu/bats/abe/	website: https://www.bellevuecollege.edu/bats/abe/
44		

Important YAML Rules

- **Keep the existing indentation.** Use spaces, not the Tab key.
- Do not remove colons (:), hyphens (-), or quotation marks unless you are sure.
- Copy web links completely, including `https://`.
- If the text contains a special character, use double quotation marks (" ").
- If when the sentence is long or multiple lines, use `>` after colons (:). Need to add indentation each line.

- To add a new item, copy an existing item with the same structure and spacing, including its hyphen or special characters. Then edit the text, and check that the hyphen and indentation are still correct.
- Update the id numbers as appropriate, if necessary.

Case	Example
Before	title: I-BEST (No I-BEST programs)
After	title: I-BEST
Multiline text edit example (ex. about-us.yml)	answer: > EFW Alumni Community is a volunteer-led community for English for Work alumni. It helps graduates stay connected after ...
Special characters edit Example (ex. Privacy.yml)	content: - The EFW Alumni Community website itself does not collect personal information directly. - "However, we may use external forms, such as Fillout Forms, for activities such as"
External Link example (ex. college.yml)	website: https://example.org/program

Not sure? Change an existing value instead of creating a new structure. Ask the developer before adding or deleting a full item if you are not sure about the format.

5.1 How to add a link to text in YAML file

To make **text clickable**, especially *faq* files or *privacy.yml* or *guidelines.yml*, put the text inside square brackets **[]**. Then put the website address or page link inside parentheses **()**.

Format	[Text shown on the page](website address or page link)
Example in YAML file	<pre>answer: > Talk Time is for members of the EFW Alumni Community. If you are an [English for Work](https://www.hopelink.org/programs/english-for-work/) please start with the [Ways to Connect](/ways-to-connect/) page.</pre> • Website address: https://www.example.org/examplelink • Internal page link: /page-permalink/ For another website, enter the complete address beginning with https://. For a page on the EFW Alumni Community website, use the page path beginning with /.
On the website	Who can join Talk Time? Talk Time is for members of the EFW Alumni Community. If you are an English for Work graduate and would like to join Alumni, please start with the Ways to Connect page.

Important Do not add a space between] and (.

For external links, always include the complete address beginning with **https://**. After editing, use **Preview changes** and carefully check the link text and address.

5.2 How to add/edit FAQ items

Navigate to: **_data/faq/**

How to add or edit FAQ items

IMPORTANT:

- Put ONE space after each colon [:]

- Keep the same indentation (spaces)

- Do not remove the dash [-]

The dash means "start of a new FAQ item"

Format:

- question: Your question here


```
# answer: Your answer here
# highlighted: true # optional
```

About /highlighted/:

```
# - highlighted: true
# → This FAQ item will also appear on FAQ section in the individual page
#
# - If highlighted is omitted, it is treated as false by default
# → The item will appear only in the Full FAQ page
#
# - Add highlighted: true for FAQ items that should appear
# on both the Full FAQ page and the individual FAQ section
```

```
# Example:
```

```
# - question: Do you have any questions?
# answer: Yes. I'll send the message.
# highlighted: true
```

5.3 How to add/edit privacy or guidelines page

Navigate to: `_data/privacy.yml` or `_data/guidelines.yml`

```
# IMPORTANT:
# - Put ONE space after each colon [:]
# - Keep the same indentation (spaces)
# - Do NOT remove the dash [-]
# The dash means "start of a new section or list item"
#
# - If the text contains special characters such as [:] [#] [@] or starts with [-],
# wrap the text with double quotes [" "]
#
# Example:
# - "Our community is a place to:"
```

```
# Adding a new section

# Each section should include:

# - id: section number

# - title: section title

# - content: paragraph text list

# - bullets: optional bullet list
```

```
# Example format:

#

# sections:

#   - id: 1

#   title: Example title

#   content:

#     - First paragraph

#     - Second paragraph

#   bullets:

#     - First bullet

#     - Second bullet
```

5.4 How to update adult education and employment resources page

Navigate to: **_data/edu-resources/**

This folder contains separate YAML files for colleges, community classes, job training, employment resources and apprenticeships section.

Select the file that contains the information you want to update.

5.4.1 Add/edit field an Existing Resource

To update a contact person, phone number, email address, website, or program description:

1. Open the correct YAML file.
2. Use Ctrl+F to find the organization, college, or program name.
3. Change only the information that needs to be updated.

4. Keep the existing field names, spacing, and indentation.
5. Select **Preview changes** and review the update.

Example

Before

```
- name: Example Training Program
  location: Seattle, WA
  info: Free career training for adults
  email: contact@example.org
  website: https://example.org/program
```

After (want to add phone info and update email address)

```
info: Free career training for adults <-existing field
phone: 111-222-1234 <-newly added field
email: new-contact@example.org <-updated field
```

5.4.2 Add new program or classes or new resource

Resource items do not always use the same fields. Some items have a phone number, email address, website, contact person, or several locations. These fields are optional and order is not matter.

The easiest way to add a new resource is to copy an existing item with a similar structure.

1. Find an item with a similar format.
2. Copy the complete item, including its first dash - and spacing.
3. Paste it under the correct section.
4. Replace the example information with the new information.
5. Remove optional fields that are not needed.
6. Confirm that the indentation has not changed.

- **Example of college format (ex.college.yml)**

colleges:

```
- name: ABC College
  location: Seattle, WA
```

programs:

- program: English

phone: 123-444-1234 (optional field)

email: esl@example.edu (optional field)

website: https://www.example.edu/esl/ (optional field)

- program: ABE

email: abe@example.edu (optional field)

website: https://www.example.edu/abe/ (optional field)

- program: I-BEST

email: ibest@example.edu (optional field)

website: https://www.example.edu/i-best/ (optional field)

- **Example of community program format** (ex.community.yml)

programs:

- name: Organization or program name

location: City, WA

info: Short description of the class or program

contact: Contact person

phone: 000-000-0000

email: contact@example.org

website: https://example.org/

- **Example of multiple Locations format**

Some organizations have more than one location or branch. In this case, use a branches section.

Copy an existing item that already uses branches, then edit the information.

- name: Example Organization

location: King County, WA

info: English and computer classes

branches:

- branch: Seattle

phone: 206-555-1111

website: <https://example.org/seattle>

- branch: Renton

phone: 425-555-2222

website: <https://example.org/renton>

- **The following fields are optional:** Contact, phone, phone2, email, email2, website, website2, SNS, branches

! Do not add an optional field if no information is available. Do not leave it empty.

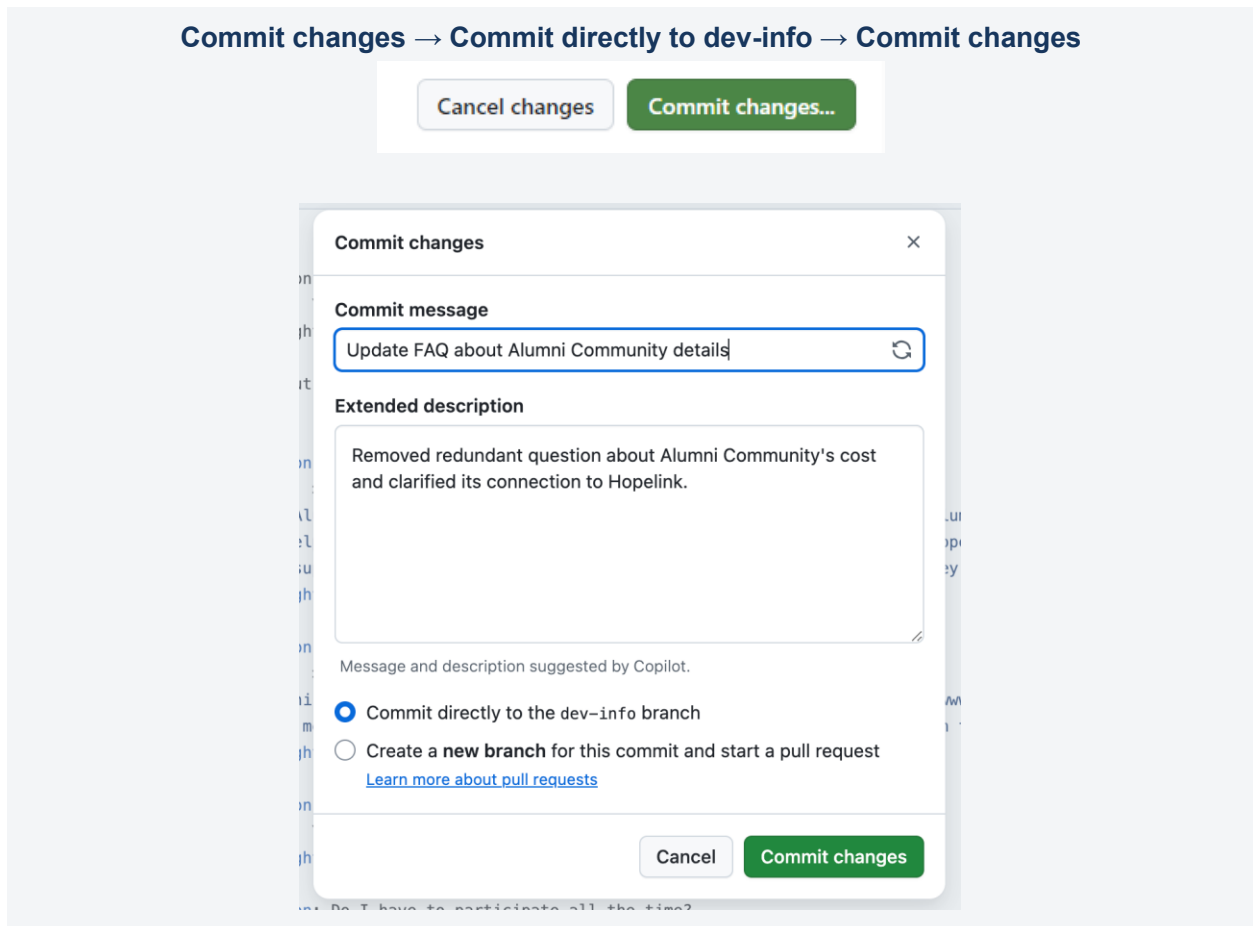
! Keep each branch and each program at the same indentation level. Each new branch/program/name must begin with a dash [-].

Not sure which format to use? Copy an existing resource that looks most similar to the new resource. Replace its content, remove fields you do not need, and confirm that the indentation level is sequential.

6. Commit the File to *dev-info*

After checking your edit, select the *Commit changes...* button. *Commit changes* pop-up will be shown.

1. In Commit message, briefly describe what you changed.
2. The Extended description is optional. Use it for extra details.
3. Select *Commit directly to the dev-info branch* option.
4. Select the *Commit changes* button to save the file.



Commit Message Examples

Item	Example
Schedule	Update Talk Time schedule
Link	Update job training program link
Description	Revise alumni community FAQ

Several values	Update adult education resource details
----------------	---

Do not select Do not select Create a new branch for this commit and start a pull request. This can make it harder to collect several file edits in one Pull Request.

When You Need to Edit Several Files

After committing one file, return to the dev-info file list and edit the next file in the same way.

1. Edit and commit the first file.
2. Edit and commit the second file.
3. Edit and commit any other files.
4. After every file is finished, create one Pull Request.

Remember The number of commits does not need to match the number of Pull Requests. Several commits can be included in one Pull Request.

7. Create the Pull Request

Create the Pull Request only after you finish all file edits.

1. Select *Pull requests* in the repository menu.
2. Select the *New pull request* button.
3. Set base to *dev*.
4. Set compare to *dev-info*.
5. Confirm that GitHub shows Able to merge or a list of changed files.
6. Open Commits and Files changed. Confirm that all your changes are included.
7. Select Create pull request.
8. Enter a title and description and after checking all, then select Create pull request again.

Pull requests → New pull request → [base: dev ← compare: dev-info]

Code Issues **Pull requests** Actions Projects Wiki Security and quality Insights Settings

Label issues and pull requests for new contributors
Now, GitHub will help potential first-time contributors [discover issues](#) labeled with [good first issue](#) [Dismiss](#)

dev-info had recent pushes less than a minute ago [Compare & pull request](#)

Filters [Labels](#) 9 [Milestones](#) 0 [New pull request](#)

Comparing changes

Choose two branches to see what's changed or to start a new pull request. If you need to, you can also [compare across forks](#) or [learn more about diff comparisons](#).

base: dev ← compare: dev-info ✓ Able to merge. These branches can be automatically merged.

Add a title *

Dev info

Add a description

Write Preview **H** **B** *I* U `<>` [@](#) [🔗](#) [📁](#) [📝](#) [🔍](#) [🔖](#) [🔗](#) [🔗](#) [🔗](#)

Add your description here...

☒ Markdown is supported ☐ Paste, drop, or click to add files

[Create pull request](#)

Reviewers [No reviews](#)

Assignees [No one—assign yourself](#)

Labels [None yet](#)

Projects [None yet](#)

Milestone [No milestone](#)

Development
Use [Closing keywords](#) in the description to automatically close issues

Helpful resources
[GitHub Community Guidelines](#)

2 commits 2 files changed 1 contributor

Commits on May 21, 2026

[Update guidelines.yml](#) [Verified](#) [27c5464](#) [<>](#)
 jenny-jhkim authored 5 minutes ago

[Update guidelines.html](#) [Verified](#) [96aa7bf](#) [<>](#)
 jenny-jhkim authored 2 minutes ago

Showing 2 changed files with 23 additions and 0 deletions. [Split](#) [Unified](#)

```

19  _data/guidelines.yml
@@ -71,3 +71,22 @@ sections:
71 71     - avoid judging mistakes
72 72     - use friendly and professional language
73 73     - support a welcoming environment
74 +   content?:
75 +     - Mistakes are a normal part of learning and speaking English. This community should be a safe place to practice.
76 +
77 +   - id: 4
78 +     title: Protect privacy
79 +     content:
80 +       - Please respect other members' privacy.

```

base: dev ← compare: dev-info

Make sure:

Check the direction The changes must move from dev-info to dev. The screen should show dev ← dev-info.

Pull Request Example

Item	Example
Title	Update September program information
Description	Updated Talk Time schedule, job training link, and FAQ wording. Please review dates and links before merging.

Use a clear title. In the description, list the files or information you changed and anything the developer should check.

8. After You Create the Pull Request

- Send the Pull Request link to the developer.
- Wait for the developer to review and merge it into *dev*.
- If the developer requests a change, edit the file again on *dev-info*.
- A new commit on *dev-info* is automatically added to the open Pull Request.

Forgot a file? Do not create another Pull Request. Edit the missing file on *dev-info* and commit it. The open Pull Request will update automatically.

If a Pull Request Is Already Open

Another administrator may already have an open *dev-info* → *dev* Pull Request.

1. Open Pull requests and check that the existing PR shows *dev* ← *dev-info*.
2. Open Files changed and confirm that your changes are included.
3. If your changes are included, do not create a new PR. Tell the PR owner or developer.

Working together Tell other administrators before you begin editing. Keep only one open *dev-info* → *dev* Pull Request whenever possible.

What Happens After the Merge

After the developer merges *dev-info* into *dev*, the developer later promotes *dev* to *main*. When the main website deployment succeeds, automation updates *dev-info* to the latest main version.

Troubleshooting

Item	Example
No Edit button	Ask the repository administrator for Write access.
Cannot find dev-info	Confirm the repository name, then search again in the branch menu.
There isn't anything to compare	The change may already be in dev, or base and compare may be reversed.
A PR already exists	Use the existing dev-info → dev Pull Request.
YAML check fails	Check indentation, colons, quotation marks, and hyphens. Send the error to the developer.
Merge conflict	Do not try to fix it unless you know how. Contact the developer.
Edited main by mistake	Stop editing and immediately send the commit or PR link to the developer.
Committed a wrong value	Edit the correct value on dev-info and add another commit.

Final Checklist

- ☐ I am signed in with an account that has access to the EFW repository.
- ☐ The current branch is dev-info.
- ☐ I edited the correct YAML file under _data.
- ☐ I kept the existing indentation and YAML structure.
- ☐ I checked the edit in Preview changes.
- ☐ I committed each file directly to dev-info.
- ☐ I finished all file edits before creating one Pull Request.
- ☐ The PR base is dev and compare is dev-info.
- ☐ I checked every file in Files changed.
- ☐ I sent the Pull Request link to the developer.

Done You are finished when the Pull Request shows base: dev, compare: dev-info, and all edited files appear under Files changed.